

Lead with Your Voice

PRIMARY TEXTS: EXODUS 17, NUMBERS 20

How do our actions demonstrate the goodness, the heart of God? How do we honor Him with our actions, choices, and our voice each day?

It might seem easy to look back through our podcast notes, verses we've highlighted, or margins we've filled in the Text, to say what we believe we should do to honor God, to be that Kingdom of priests, in a given moment.

Love others. Love Him with all of our heart, soul, and might. To trust Him and His story. To trust that He loves us, each and every one, simply because He made us—and don't forget that He made you in His image, just as He did the one sitting across the table or party line or church pew.

But when reality comes—the beast crouches at the door, the well runs dry, our lands remain barren, or empire-driven oppression becomes rampant and celebrated—how will we be different like God is different?

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God is different?**

If we look ahead to the Gospels and the life of Jesus, we get a clearer picture—but right here, right now, sitting in the desert of Exodus and Numbers, it doesn't seem that easy. Simple, perhaps, but easy? No. Whether we call these times a test, an assessment, or a check-in, these decisive moments grow us, leaving stretch marks on our hearts and growing pains in our souls. We, like Moses, will never be the same.

Moses had so many of those *very* human moments. His successes, failures, and range of emotions make him all the more relatable to many of us. Perhaps it was his anger. Perhaps it was his grief. Perhaps it was losing sight of the story or the voice of the Shepherd for a brief moment that led him to strike out with force rather than continue to lead Israel with His voice. But is the *why* in this story what matters?

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The images of the wilderness—*rotem bush*, *ar'ar*, *En Gedi*—stick with us for a reason. Maybe this story renews our hope in the beauty of the *acacia* tree. Moses may not have seen the Promised Land, the blooming and full growth and life of the acacia that would be Israel, but he helped plant the seeds that got them there. Making this not just a story of why or simply of Moses's final big screw-up, but also God putting a hand on Moses's shoulder and saying "You've done enough. You can pass on the figurative baton, or staff, now."

So what can we carry with us from this story? How should we fight against or work through our anger or rage or grief to still demonstrate and honor the heart of God?

Sarah Bessey answers this with something along the lines of “Don’t let your anger turn to bitterness.” This has become an important mantra for me to hold to in recent months. These emotions aren’t evil, they’re human, and God feels them too. He asks us to listen for Him before those emotions make us bitter and vengeful, hoping that we’ll begin to sound just a bit more like Him each day.

**“Don’t let your
anger turn to
bitterness.”**

Easy? Most definitely not. But simple? Maybe.

So may we choose to be, when it is easy and when it is not, instruments of peace. Lovers of justice. Gardeners of creation. Sheep following the Shepherd. Houses built on solid ground. Streams of living water. Refuge and shade in the desert. Partners in putting the world back together—broken piece after broken piece.

May we choose to demonstrate God’s goodness, His heart, each day. And, in those times when we don’t, may we make space to listen for His voice once again, trust in the acacias we’ve planted before, and choose to do better tomorrow.

PRAYER

God,

*May we always remember
that You are different,
calling us to be different too.*

*May we humbly walk along this journey
looking for ways to serve as Your priests,
Your Kingdom, Your shade, Your partners
in blessing the world.*

*Leading with our voices, trembling yet strong,
may we sound more like You each passing day,
setting aside our power, wealth, anger, and self
to love You, and others, with all of
our heart, our soul, our “very.”*

Amen

THE FOUR PILLARS

EPISODE 30

BEMA Discipleship is built on four pillars; a **Four-Pillared Perspective** to help us remember **to elevate the words of God** (not ours) and help us identify the principles that we see recurring in the Story of God's people.

Here are some applications for this episode echoing the ideas of the four pillars:



TEXT

What might be important to dig into again, meditate over, or memorize from these passages of Exodus and Numbers? What part of the Text may you want to just sit with?



COMMUNITY

How does your community seek to lead by your voice rather than power or force? How does your community seek to move on from mistakes, disagreements, to lead differently?



DISCIPLESHIP

Not only does this story challenge us to make disciples, but to do so in the right way. Who can you walk alongside to bring teaching and hope into their life? To model how to lead with one's voice and become more like Jesus each day?



WRESTLING

What are you wrestling with? The reason why Moses struck the rock? Why God kept him from the Promised Land? Keep asking questions. Remember, questions and wrestling are good! Especially in community. How can you wrestle with this together?



Are you a music listener?

Listen along to our BEMA Music Playlists on Spotify.

Song suggestions? Send them to bemabesorah@gmail.com.



BEMA SESSION 1



MEDITATION & PRAYER

REFLECTION, APPLICATION & IMPACT

There are three emphases we are always thinking about in terms of application at BEMA. These may be stated explicitly at times, but often we will want you to do the work of finding ways to connect the dots to the things we are learning. Much of this is what makes the work of BEMA distinct as a ministry of Impact Campus Ministries.

CREATING A SPACE SPIRITUAL FORMATION

*We believe that **if we do our part in creating space for God, He will fill it**, and the more we let Him fill that space, the more able and willing we may become to lead with our voice. What spiritual practices might you need to connect with God more? How might the smallest practice fill you with more of Him to better lead others? What practice could you refine, pick up again, or challenge yourself to try for the first time? If you create the space, He will fill it.*

CONSIDERING CAMPUS YOUNG PEOPLE FOCUS

*We believe young adults are shaping the future, and they need to see what good, faithful leaders look like—and this can happen through people like you! **They need to see what it looks like to follow God in the weakest of moments, do better each day, and continue to listen to God's instruction.** Be on the lookout for those young people who may cross your path that God may be asking you to lead or disciple.*

SACRED STATION THEOLOGY OF WORK

*Imagine how our world, our theology of work, might be different if we chose not to lead with our power and strength, but with a voice that sounds like that of our good God? To walk, and work, in hope and trust? Living in intimacy with God is how you can lead and live this way as you pursue your 9–5. Does your physical work put you in a position to lead others the way Jesus calls us to? The way we manage our employees, interact with customers or coworkers, care for our children, or create products can make an impact. **You are doing sacred work and God is there to continue doing this work in and through you in whatever sacred space you are in.***